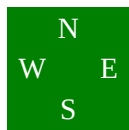


Board 1

South Deals
None Vul

♠ 9 6 3
♥ A 10 9 8
♦ A Q 5
♣ J 10 9

♠ 7 4 2
♥ K Q J 6 5
♦ 7 3
♣ A 8 3



♠ 10 8 5
♥ 3
♦ K 10 9 2
♣ 7 6 5 4 2

♠ A K Q J
♥ 7 4 2
♦ J 8 6 4
♣ K Q

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2♦	Pass	2♥
Pass	3NT	Pass	4♥
All Pass			
4♥ by South			

Partner's 2♦ bid is a transfer; you respond 2♥.
Partner now bids 3NT.

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Partner now bids 3NT.

Partner tells you that he has enough points to be in game, and that he holds exactly 5♥s. With your 3♥s you know of an 8-card Major fit so you correct the contract to 4♥.

South plays 4♥. West leads the ♣J. You win the opening lead with your ♣Q.

Loser List: ♠ = 0 : ♥ = ? : ♦ = 2 : ♣ = 0 :: Total = ?

The 2♦ losers are unavoidable, and even you will have to give up a trick to the Ace of trumps. So you have to make sure not to lose a second♥.

Win the ♣Q and play a small♥ to dummy's♥J, which holds the trick.

I hope you didn't continue drawing trumps by playing the♥K. If you did then you are going down in an ice-cold contract.

The way to lose only one♥ trick is to keep leading toward dummy's honors. So come to your hand with a black card and play another♥ in that direction, leading through West's♥A. When you win that trick repeat the maneuver.

It is really against the odds for West to hold♥ A 10 9 x. In fact it would only occur perhaps one time in seven.

But there is no reason to go down once every seven times when you don't need to.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ 8 7 6 3
♥ 9 4
♦ 10 5 2
♣ Q J 10 4

♠ A K J 5
♥ A J 10 5
♦ A 6 4
♣ 8 3



♠ 10 9 2
♥ Q 7 3
♦ 9 8 7
♣ K 9 6 2

♠ Q 4
♥ K 8 6 2
♦ K Q J 3
♣ A 7 5

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♥
Pass	6♥		
All Pass			

6♥ by South
your winners.

The 2♣ bid was Stayman, so you bid your ♥s.

Partner takes the direct approach and puts you in slam.

South plays 6♥. West leads the ♣Q. West finds their best lead, exposing your ♣ loser right off the bat.

Loser List: ♠ = 0 : ♥ = 1 : ♦ = 0 : ♣ = 1 :: Total = 2

If you can guess the ♥ finesse correctly you will make 7, discarding dummy's ♣ loser on the fourth ♦. But if you guess wrong they will immediately set you with a ♣ trick.

There is a better way - one that combines two chances. Win the ♣A. Then play your ♥A and ♥K. If the ♥Q happens to fall, pull the last trump and run

If the ♥Q **DOESN'T** fall, (she won't of course), switch to ♦s. On the fourth round of ♦s discard dummy's ♣, whether it is ruffed with the ♥Q or not.

If you knew to play the East for the ♥Q then you wouldn't need this improved plan.

But playing the deal as described will win whenever the ♥Q is doubleton, **OR** when the player with the protected ♥Q holds at least 3 ♦s.

Pretty good odds, better than the going rate for finesses, which is 50% off.

There was an alternate plan, just as good. After taking the two top trumps, run the ♠s, discarding two ♣s from your hand. As you see, either would have worked.